

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

DOW JONES | News Corp

FRIDAY, FEBRUARY 27, 2026 ~ VOL. CCLXXXVII NO. 47

WSJ.com

★★★★ \$5.00

DJIA 49499.20 ▲ 17.05 0.03% NASDAQ 22878.38 ▼ 1.2% STOXX 600 633.18 ▼ 0.05% 10-YR. TREAS. ▲ 8/32, yield 4.016% OIL \$65.21 ▼ \$0.21 GOLD \$5,176.50 ▼ \$31.50 EURO \$1.1800 YEN 156.14

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **Paramount emerged** victorious in the fight to buy Warner Bros. Discovery as Netflix said it wouldn't match the David Ellison-led company's latest offer for the iconic Hollywood property. **A1, B4**

◆ **Mortgage rates fell** below 6% this week for the first time in more than three years, welcome news for house hunters bound for the spring home-buying season. **A1**

◆ **A decline in Nvidia** shares helped drag down the Nasdaq by 1.2% in a session that saw the S&P 500 shed 0.5% and the Dow rise less than 0.1%. **B9**

◆ **At least 1,800 companies** have filed lawsuits seeking refunds for tariffs they paid under Trump's initiative before the Supreme Court ruled them to be illegal. **A1**

◆ **Stellantis said** the re-launch of popular products such as its gas-guzzling eight-cylinder "Hemis" would power it back to profitability this year, after a retreat from electric vehicles. **B1**

◆ **Redfin will display** information about Compass's exclusive home listings on its website, offering buyers their first chance to view that information on a major real-estate portal. **B1**

◆ **Vanguard agreed** to pay several U.S. states \$29.5 million to settle a lawsuit alleging it conspired with other index-fund managers to pressure coal companies to reduce their output. **B1**

◆ **Walmart agreed** to pay \$100 million to settle Federal Trade Commission claims that the retailer misled delivery drivers about the pay and tips that could earn. **B2**

Worldwide

◆ **Hillary Clinton said** she repeatedly told members of a Republican-led House committee that she had no knowledge of Jeffrey Epstein's wrongdoing, characterizing the lengthy closed-door deposition as a partisan fishing exercise. **A1**

◆ **Newly released** documents show how JPMorgan Chase bankers maintained ties with Epstein for years as he helped manage the fortune of Apollo co-founder Leon Black. **A1**

◆ **The head of the World Economic Forum** is stepping down from the role over his connections with Epstein. **A4**

◆ **A Columbia student** who was detained by federal immigration officials at a university building early Thursday was released later in the day, the school said. **A3**

◆ **A federal judge in Washington, D.C.,** declined to block the construction of Trump's White House ballroom, on the site where the East Wing once stood. **A6**

◆ **Pollution from U.S. power plants** rose last year, a rare uptick in an otherwise long-term downward trend, partly because more coal was being burned to generate electricity. **A3**

◆ **The U.S. brought** tough demands to a crucial round of nuclear talks with Iran in Geneva and sent more aircraft and warships to the Middle East. **A8**

◆ **Anthropic said** it wouldn't back down in a dispute with the Pentagon over AI guardrails ahead of a deadline on resolving the issue. **A3**

◆ **Canadian leader Carney** departed for India in a bid to ease strained relations and deepen commercial ties. **A9**

CONTENTS	Markets..... B9
Arts in Review A11-12	Markets Digest... B6
Business & Finance B2-3	Opinion..... A13-15
Crossword..... A12	Sports..... A16
From Page One..... A10	Technology..... B4
Heard on Street..... B10	U.S. News..... A2-4,6
Mansion..... M1-12	World News..... A8-9



© 2026 Dow Jones & Company, Inc. All Rights Reserved

Paramount Wins Warner Bid

Netflix's decision to bow out of contest clinches tie-up of entertainment giants

By JOE FLINT

Paramount emerged victorious in the fight to buy Warner Bros. Discovery as Netflix said it would not match the rival's latest offer for the iconic Hollywood property.

Netflix pulled the plug on its deal soon after the Warner board of directors said it determined Paramount's \$31-per-

share offer for the entire company was superior to Netflix's bid for Warner's movie and television studios and HBO Max streaming service. Paramount is now poised to take control of the entertainment company home to properties and brands including HBO, Superman and Harry Potter.

"We've always been disciplined, and at the price required to match Paramount Skydance's latest offer, the deal is no longer financially attractive, so we are declining to match," Netflix Co-CEOs Ted Sarandos and Greg Peters said in a statement. "This

transaction was always a 'nice to have' at the right price, not a 'must have' at any price," the pair said.

Pending regulatory approval, Paramount will own not only Warner Bros. and HBO, but also many popular cable networks including CNN, TNT, TBS and Food Network. The deal would represent a major ground shift for the entertainment industry, which is trying to adapt to seismic shifts in audience habits and technology.

"Once our board votes to adopt the Paramount merger agreement, it will create tre-

mendous value for our shareholders," said Warner Discovery CEO David Zaslav.

The development marks a stunning come-from-behind win for Paramount, whose overtures had previously been rebuffed at every turn by Warner. After multiple unsolicited bids from Paramount last year, Warner opened a sale process that ended with Netflix as the winning suitor. Netflix in December signed a deal to buy Warner's studios and

Please turn to page A2

◆ **Warner Bros. Discovery revenue falls nearly 6%...** B4

Mamdani Peddles NYC Housing Plan to Trump



ODD COUPLE: New York City Mayor Zohran Mamdani visited President Trump to discuss building 12,000 housing units. He gave Trump a copy of a famous tabloid edition, right, and a fake one. The mayor posted this photo on his X account. **A3**

Clinton Blasts Her Deposition As Fishing Expedition

CHAPPAQUA, N.Y.—Hillary Clinton said she repeatedly told members of a Republican-led House committee that she had no knowledge of Jeffrey Epstein's wrongdoing, characterizing the lengthy closed-door deposition as a partisan fishing expedition.

The former secretary of

By Jennifer Calfas, Ken Thomas and Anvee Bhutani

state said Thursday that she had no information to share about any criminal activity by the convicted sex offender or his associate Ghislaine Maxwell and that the House Oversight Committee should instead be calling President Trump to give a deposition over his past relationship with Epstein.

"I don't know how many times I had to say I did not know Jeffrey Epstein. I never went to his island. I never went to his homes. I never went to his offices. So it's on the record numerous times," Clinton told reporters after the all-day session concluded. In a statement earlier in the day, she said she was called to testify "in order to distract attention from President Trump's actions."

Hillary Clinton's deposition came ahead of former President Bill Clinton's testimony, which is scheduled for Friday. The testimony is taking place at a performing-arts center near their home in Chappaqua. The extraordinary circumstances involving the Epstein case marked the first time a former first lady and former president were speaking to a congressional committee under subpoena.

Oversight Committee Chair Rep. James Comer (R., Ky.) *Please turn to page A4*

JPMorgan Dumped Epstein, But Its Bankers Stayed Close

By ALEXANDER SAEEDY

JPMorgan Chase has said it fired Jeffrey Epstein as a client in 2013. Newly released documents show how its bankers maintained ties with the convicted sex offender for years as he helped manage Apollo Global Management co-founder Leon Black's fortune.

Two JPMorgan managing directors, Justin Nelson and Paul Barrett, used their connection to Epstein to develop a commercial relationship between the bank and Black's family office starting in 2014,

recently released documents show. Nelson had been Epstein's banker before the bank kicked Epstein out in 2013, while Barrett had helped find investments for him.

The Wall Street Journal reported in 2023 that Nelson and Barrett had scheduled multiple meetings with Epstein from 2014 to 2017. JPMorgan said at the time that any meeting held with Epstein after 2013 was regarding other JPMorgan bank clients whom Epstein represented. Nelson remains a senior banker at JPMorgan while Barrett left in 2017 to

work directly for Epstein.

Documents released in the past several months by the Justice Department and Congress show the extent of the two senior bankers' interactions with Epstein. Dozens of emails show the crucial role that Epstein played in helping the bankers pitch business to Black and meet wealthy individuals.

Joseph Evangelisti, a JPMorgan spokesman, reiterated that the bank "fired" Epstein

Please turn to page A4

◆ **World Economic Forum head quits over Epstein ties** A4

Mortgage Rates Fall Below 6%, Lowest Since 2022

By NICOLE FRIEDMAN AND GINA HEEB

Mortgage rates fell below 6% this week for the first time in more than three years, welcome news for waves of house hunters heading into the busy spring home-buying season.

The average rate for a 30-year fixed mortgage was 5.98% this week, the lowest level since September 2022 and a slight decline from last week, Freddie Mac said Thursday.

Mortgage rates briefly topped 7% in January last year, but they have fallen steadily over the past several months. Cooling inflation and economic uncertainty have helped bring them down, and the Federal Reserve's three interest-rate cuts in the second half of 2025 added to the momentum.

Lenders, real-estate agents and economists said this week's drop below 6% could mark an important psychological

Please turn to page A2

Companies Rush to Get Their Tariff Money Back

President Trump's far-reaching global tariffs netted at least \$130 billion in the 10 months they were in effect. For businesses, getting a refund could take far longer.

By Louise Radnofsky, Lydia Wheeler and Chao Deng

Since the U.S. Supreme Court struck down many of Trump's tariffs last week, dozens of companies have rushed to court to try to get their money back, joining hundreds of others who filed suits in anticipation of the court's ruling.

To date, at least 1,800 companies have filed lawsuits seeking refunds, according to a Wall Street Journal analysis, with more joining the rolls every day. Most—including well-known names like Costco Wholesale, Goodyear Tire &

Please turn to page A6

◆ **The math behind Trump's economic plans.....** A2

Americans Are Leaving the U.S. In Record Numbers

More citizens are replanting overseas, enabled by America's enviable salaries

By DREW HINSHAW AND JOE PARKINSON

In its 250th year, is America, land of immigration, becoming a country of emigration?

Last year the U.S. experienced something that hasn't definitively occurred since the Great Depression: More people moved out than moved in. The Trump administration has hailed the exodus—negative net migration—as the fulfillment of its promise to ramp up deportations and restrict new visas. Beneath the stormy optics of that immigration crackdown, however, lies a less-noticed reversal: America's own citizens are leaving in record numbers, replanting themselves and their families in lands they find more afford-

able and safe.

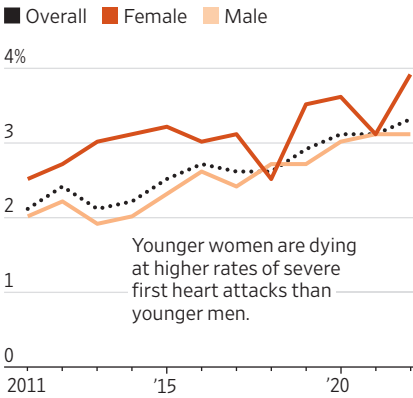
Since the Eisenhower administration, the U.S. hasn't collected comprehensive statistics on the number of citizens leaving. Yet data on residence permits, foreign home purchases, student enrollments and other metrics from more than 50 countries show that Americans are voting with their feet to an unprecedented degree. A millions-strong diaspora is studying, telecommuting and retiring overseas.

The new American dream, for some of its citizens, is to no longer live there.

In the cobblestoned streets of Lisbon, so many Americans are snapping up apartments that the newest arrivals complain they mostly hear their own language—not Portu-

Please turn to page A10

Percentage of severe first heart attacks that resulted in death



Note: For hospitalized people ages 18-54
Source: Journal of the American Heart Association

Heart Attacks' New Toll

The proportion of adults ages 18 to 54 who died in a hospital of a severe first heart attack rose 57% between 2011 and 2022, according to a study published Thursday in the Journal of the American Heart Association. **A3**

The Sickest Burns on the Internet Come From French Bureaucrats

Nation's diplomats said nothing for ages. Now they have a comeback for everything.

By SAM SCHECHNER AND NOEMIE BISSEBEE

PARIS—When French authorities raided X's offices over alleged distribution of child sexual-abuse material, owner Elon Musk took to his account to call it "a political attack."

Two hours later, French diplomats shot back on X, referencing Jeffrey Epstein: "Maybe that logic flies on some island. Doesn't fly in France."

Some of the sickest burns on the internet right now are coming out of the French Foreign Ministry. *Please turn to page A10*